

MORNING BRIEFING — MONDAY 24 AUGUST 2026

Generated 24 August 2026 • 06:30 BST (London) • Data collected 22-24 August 2026 • latest confirmed cash-market session: Friday 21 August 2026 (weekend — no Saturday/Sunday trading) • Reference timezone: Europe/London (BST = UTC+1)

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Iran vows it "will not submit" as US pivots to economic warfare; Strait of Hormuz traffic near 20% of normal

[CNN](#) / [Al Jazeera](#) / [Bloomberg](#) • [weekend, 22 Aug 2026](#)

Trump has vowed the "most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" against Iran; Treasury Secretary Bessent pledged unprecedented sanctions. Bloomberg warns the isolation push risks provoking Iranian strikes across the Gulf. Keeps an active oil-supply and shipping-risk premium in the market into Monday's open — the dominant swing factor for energy and safe-haven assets this week.

US stocks bounced Friday but still closed the week lower after a bond-market sell-off

[CNBC](#) / [TheStreet](#) • [Friday 21 Aug 2026 close](#)

S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq all rose Friday, but the S&P still finished roughly 1.4% lower on the week as long-end Treasury yields spiked (30-year near a 19-year high). Sets a cautious, yield-sensitive tone for the European open.

Eurozone flash Composite PMI hits 9-month high of 52.1; German manufacturing output at a 54-month high

[S&P Global](#) / [FXStreet](#) • [Friday 21 Aug 2026](#)

Growth led by German AI-tech and defence-goods demand. A rare upside macro surprise for the eurozone, contrasting with the region's stagnant growth narrative earlier in the year — supportive for European cyclical if it holds through the week.

China's industrial output and retail sales miss forecasts; composite PMI output falls to a 12-month low

[Bloomberg](#) • [17 Aug 2026 \(pre-weekend, still driving sentiment\)](#)

Industrial output growth slowed to 4.5% y/y (below consensus); composite PMI output index at 49.3. Weighs on the Asia-exposed European names (miners, luxury, autos) and tempers the read-through from Friday's Hang Seng/Shanghai gains.

Jackson Hole 2026: Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first keynote lands Friday 28 August

[TechTimes](#) / [BigGo Finance](#) • [21 Aug 2026](#)

Goldman Sachs has flagged the speech could "significantly amplify" FX volatility. Warsh has held the policy rate at 3.50–3.75% since taking over from Powell and has signalled a rate hike isn't his preferred inflation tool. His first major public policy signal as Chair is this week's dominant macro catalyst, alongside Wednesday's Nvidia earnings.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	EXPECTED MOVE	COLLECTION TIME
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	n/a	n/a	—
DAX futures	n/a	n/a	—
CAC 40 futures	n/a	n/a	—
FTSE 100 futures	n/a	n/a	—
US futures — context			
S&P 500 e-mini	n/a	n/a	—
Nasdaq 100 e-mini	n/a	n/a	—

No verifiable live pre-open futures quote could be sourced for Monday's session as of the 06:30 BST collection window (weekend markets closed, live quote feeds not accessible via web search). Context from week-ahead previews: this is a heavy catalyst week — Nvidia earnings Wednesday, US PCE inflation data, and Jackson Hole (Warsh's keynote Friday). Brent crude near two-week highs on the Iran standoff is flagged as a headwind for risk sentiment into the open. Verify live futures levels via a terminal (Bloomberg/Refinitiv) before trading on this section.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 21 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,458	+0.60%
DAX 40	26,136.56	+0.56%
CAC 40	8,484.43	+0.37%
FTSE 100	10,816.56	+0.60%

European indices rebounded Friday after a rough week dominated by rising bond yields, elevated oil and geopolitical uncertainty over Iran. The move was broad-based rather than sector-specific — DAX back above 26,000, best single-day gain in the region since early August. Still, several outlets flagged the week itself as one of the weakest multi-week stretches in a decade for European equities.

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (FRIDAY 21 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,674.37	+0.43%	Weekly loss despite Friday bounce
Dow Jones Industrial Average	53,277.01	+0.98%	+517.80 pts
Nasdaq Composite	26,180.45	+0.43%	+113.29 pts

Risk-on rebound Friday, but all three indices still posted a weekly loss after a Treasury-driven sell-off pushed the 30-year yield near a 19-year high (~5.31–5.33%) and the 10-year to ~4.70–4.74%. Leaders: financials and crypto-linked names (Robinhood +~14%, Coinbase +~8% on the week) as Bitcoin hit its best week in two years (~\$77,000); energy also firm on the Iran-driven oil rally. Laggards: technology, down more than 3% over five days, alongside consumer staples/discretionary and healthcare. Key takeaway: the bounce reflects relief in equities and crypto even as long-end yields stayed elevated, with new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh signalling a rate hike is not his preferred inflation tool and Bessent's Iran-sanctions rhetoric adding a geopolitical layer.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	66,016.36	−0.30%
Hang Seng	26,009.46	+1.21%
Shanghai Composite	3,905.2	+0.04%
Kospi (South Korea)	6,912.95	+0.88%

Figures reflect Friday 21 Aug close — Monday's Asian session had not yet reported at the 06:30 BST collection window.

Mixed-to-positive tone. Hong Kong and mainland China gains driven by fresh Beijing policy-support signals (Vice Finance Minister Liao Min pledging more fiscal spending toward households and consumption) and a tech-sector rebound (Zhongji Innolight, Eoptolink, CATL among gainers). Japan lagged, weighed by yen and yield dynamics as accelerating inflation strengthens the case for a BOJ hike. Shanghai and Shenzhen remained down for the week overall despite Friday's calm session, consistent with the softer China activity data.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
Brent (ICE, USD/bbl)	~93.90	+0.10%	Fri 21 Aug close
WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl)	~86.64	-0.22%	Fri 21 Aug close
Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz)	~4,600-4,662	+1.4-2.0% day / +~5% week	Fri 21 Aug close
Natural gas — Henry Hub (USD/MMBtu)	2.81	avg 2.74 since prompt	19 Aug (stale)
Natural gas — TTF (EUR/MWh)	~66.30	+~6% over the month	Fri 21 Aug
Copper (COMEX, USD/lb)	~6.45-6.70 (range, unconfirmed)	near record highs	mid-Aug reference

Brent and WTI stayed elevated near two-week highs, supported by the US-Iran standoff and Ukrainian strikes on Russian refineries/ports disrupting fuel supply; Brent is on track for a second straight ~5% weekly gain. Gold hit its highest level since mid-May on broad dollar weakness after the US Treasury unexpectedly widened its long-bond buyback programme, plus renewed fiscal-sustainability concerns as US national debt hit a record \$40 trillion. European TTF gas rose on a maritime blockade stranding Qatari LNG cargoes, forcing European buyers into costlier competition with Asian buyers. Copper remains near all-time highs on US tariff speculation (a potential 15-30% import duty under review), Strait of Hormuz-linked sulphuric acid supply losses, and a China export ban — but the exact Friday print could not be pinned down with confidence, hence the range.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
US 10-year Treasury yield	~4.70-4.74%	near multi-month highs	Fri 21 Aug
US 30-year Treasury yield	~5.31-5.33%	19-year high	week of 17-21 Aug
German 10-year Bund yield	~3.25-3.27%	multi-decade high	Fri 21 Aug
EUR/USD	~1.1677	broadly flat	exact timestamp unconfirmed
GBP/USD	~1.3645	broadly flat	exact timestamp unconfirmed
DXY (US Dollar Index)	~98.66-98.82	—~1% on the week	Fri 21 Aug

Treasury yields whipsawed all week: they fell sharply midweek after Bessent announced doubling the debt-buyback programme (from \$2bn to \$4bn per operation, running Sept-Nov), rebounded, then finished near cycle highs as the relief rally "fizzled out." The German Bund at a multi-decade high reflects eurozone inflation and fiscal-spending concerns plus energy pass-through from the TTF gas spike. The dollar's weekly decline is tied directly to the buyback news and concerns that yield-suppression efforts could erode dollar support — a dynamic also feeding the gold rally. EUR/USD and GBP/USD levels above should be treated as approximate; exact Friday timestamps could not be confirmed with certainty.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S / RECENT ISSUANCES

ISSUER	CURRENCY	SIZE	MATURITY	COUPON / SPREAD	NOTES
SEB (Skandinaviska Enskilda Banken)	EUR	500m	11NC6 (Tier 2)	~triple-digit spread, 4%+ yield	Reopened the euro FIG market after the summer hiatus; ~3x covered; low single-digit bp new-issue concession. Exact pricing date unconfirmed.
Other EUR corporate IG/HY	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	No further single-name deal terms sourced via public search; GlobalCapital/IFR full text blocked. Trend confirmed: "Euro IG corporate bond NIPs climb as books thin" (seasonal, late-August lull).
US IG (context)	USD	n/a per deal	n/a	n/a	19 issuers priced in a single day in mid-Aug, most in seven months; record 2026 pace (~\$1.4tn YTD, +9% vs. 2020's record). Hyperscalers (Alphabet, Amazon, Meta) among top borrowers funding AI/data-centre capex.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK

No named mandates were found for the week of 24 August. Commentary instead centres on the September reopening: bankers quoted by GlobalCapital say a stable-rates backdrop and strong demand give issuers reason to move early, before the "post-summer rush." Corporate hybrids are flagged as the hottest segment heading into autumn — 2026 YTD hybrid issuance already ~€31bn (vs €42bn for all of 2025), books averaging ~6x covered, with Stellantis cited as a cyclical name using hybrids to defend its IG rating. Analysts flag emerging concerns over exuberance and weaker call protection. Q3 euro-area government issuance is seen up ~5% to just under €110bn, roughly half concentrated in September.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL (BPS)	MOVE / DIRECTION
iTraxx Europe Main 5Y	n/a	—
iTraxx Europe Crossover 5Y	~315-320 (mid-May reference)	stale — tightening trend through H1 2026
CDX IG 5Y (USD)	n/a	—
US HY OAS (ICE BofA, proxy)	271	as of 12 Aug — near historically tight levels
US IG OAS (ICE BofA, proxy)	~80	as of 30 Jul — near historically tight levels
Average euro corporate IG spread	n/a	—

Live iTraxx Main/Crossover and euro IG OAS levels require Bloomberg Terminal, Refinitiv Eikon or ICE access — not obtainable via public web search this morning.

COMMENTARY

The primary window is technically open but thin. SEB's cleanly 3x-covered Tier 2 reopener suggests FIG investor appetite is intact once deals appear, and syndicate desks reportedly expect a busy few months once September proper begins. Rising new-issue premiums signal caution rather than closure — a typical late-August pattern as summer order books thin out. Corporate hybrids (industrials, utilities) are the most-watched segment for the autumn pipeline; no specific transport or energy-sector primary activity was found this cycle. Broader backdrop: funds enter the reopening with historically tight spreads, elevated fiscal-driven govvie supply from Germany and France, and AI-capex-driven hyperscaler issuance still dominating the USD side.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR

TIME (LONDON)	ZONE	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
13:30	US	Chicago Fed National Activity Index (July)	prior −0.02	MEDIUM
All day	US	Treasury bill auctions	n/a	LOW/MEDIUM
Eurozone/UK/US flash PMIs already released Friday 21 Aug — not repeated Monday. Later this week:				
09:30 (Tue 25 Aug)	Germany	Ifo Business Climate Index (August)	n/a	HIGH
After close (Wed 26 Aug)	US	Nvidia Q2 FY2027 earnings	n/a	HIGH
Thu–Sat 27–29 Aug	US	Jackson Hole Economic Policy Symposium; Fed Chair Warsh keynote Friday	n/a	HIGH

Monday itself is a light data day — most eurozone/UK/US PMI releases already landed Friday. The week's real catalysts are Wednesday's Nvidia earnings and Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote on Friday, which Goldman Sachs has flagged as a potential source of significant FX volatility.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

COMPANY	MARKET	EVENT	TIME
Tritax Big Box REIT (BBOX)	LSE	General meeting seeking approval for a ~£350m share issue to fund two new London data centres (235MW secured grid connections)	Monday, London
Airbus (AIR)	Euronext Paris	Spanish union three-hour stoppage Monday, lead-in to broader strike action from Tuesday 25 Aug across UK/Spain/France plants	Monday
Boeing (BA)	NYSE	SPEEA union (~17,000 technicians/engineers) rejected the latest contract offer (64–72% no votes); strike-risk overhang into the week	Ongoing

No major large-cap US or European earnings were flagged specifically for Monday — earnings season is largely past peak. The data-centre and aerospace-labour storylines are the notable corporate threads for the session.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Airbus (AIR.PA) — Paris	Spanish union strike action begins Monday, escalating Tuesday across UK/Spain/France plants. Production and delivery-timeline risk into the week.	Down / watch
Boeing (BA) — NYSE	SPEEA members rejected the latest contract offer by a wide margin. Rising strike risk for engineers and technicians.	Down / watch
Tritax Big Box REIT (BBOX.L) — London	GM vote outcome on the £350m raise and data-centre pipeline expansion. Positive if approved smoothly, given the earnings-growth target attached to the capex plan.	Watch
Freeport-McMoRan (FCX) — NYSE	Copper strength on LME backwardation, falling inventories and China restocking; also tariff-speculation tailwind for US-exposed miners.	Up / watch
Gold miners (e.g. Newmont) — multiple listings	Gold near \$4,600-4,660/oz, its highest since mid-May. Sector reported to have surged over 20% in the past week on the dollar-weakness / fiscal-concern trade.	Up
ArcelorMittal (MT.AS) — Amsterdam	Up 65.3% year-to-date, among the STOXX 600's top performers. Momentum and broker-note flow likely to continue amid the copper/metals rally.	Watch / up
UniCredit (UCG.MI) / Commerzbank (CBK.DE)	Italian-German bank M&A saga remains live per recent dealmaking coverage. Headline risk both ways this week.	Watch
Tanker / shipping names	Strait of Hormuz traffic near 20% of the pre-conflict average; Brent near two-week highs. Freight-rate and charter optionality in focus for tanker owners.	Up / watch
Airlines (e.g. IAG, Lufthansa)	Elevated jet-fuel costs from the Iran-driven Brent rally are a margin headwind. Lufthansa's earlier guidance cut cited fuel costs, though the exact date could not be confirmed this cycle.	Down / watch
AT&S (Austria)	Up 343.5% year-to-date, Europe's second-best performer in 2026. AI data-centre capex tailwind continues to draw analyst attention.	Watch / up

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US 30-year yield at a 19-year high: ~5.31–5.33%, driven by heavy debt issuance and stubborn inflation concerns, despite the Treasury's expanded buyback programme.

Eurozone surprise upside: Flash Composite PMI at a 9-month high (52.1); German manufacturing output at a 54-month high, led by AI-tech and defence-goods demand.

China slowdown: Industrial output growth slowed to 4.5% y/y in July (missed forecasts); composite PMI output index fell to a 12-month low of 49.3.

Fed under Warsh: First Jackson Hole keynote as Chair lands Friday 28 August. A Bank of America fund-manager survey found a majority expect a "neutral" tone, though Goldman flags volatility risk either way.

CORPORATE

Nvidia earnings Wednesday: Q2 FY2027 results after the close — a key catalyst for global tech sentiment this week.

Tesla +5.14% Friday: Nevada's Clark County approved commercial robotaxi operations for up to 5,000 vehicles.

National Australia Bank: Lost roughly A\$10bn in market value over the past week after disclosing home-loan applications down 15% in Q3 and cutting mortgage-growth guidance amid a weakening Australian housing market. Relevant to sentiment in Asia-exposed European financials.

Lufthansa / Zalando guidance cuts: Earlier-August profit warnings were reported (Lufthansa citing fuel costs tied to the Iran conflict; Zalando trimming 2026 guidance) but exact dates could not be pinned down this cycle — flagged as unconfirmed/older news.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

US-Iran economic warfare: New sanctions, a naval blockade, and pressure on Iran's trading partners followed the expiry of a 60-day MOU deadline on 17 August without a final deal. Strait of Hormuz traffic remains near 20% of its pre-conflict average.

Gulf escalation risk: Bloomberg analysis warns the isolation strategy could provoke Iranian strikes across the Gulf — the single largest tail risk for oil and shipping this week.

Russia-Ukraine: No confirmed ceasefire or negotiating breakthrough over the weekend; sticking points (Donbas territory, security guarantees) remain unresolved per the most recent available coverage.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. US-Iran economic warfare escalation

Hormuz traffic near 20% of normal keeps a live shipping and oil-supply risk premium in the market through the European session.

2. Eurozone PMI upside digestion

Friday's 9-month-high composite PMI (52.1) is the main fresh macro data point European desks are still pricing in.

3. Bond-market stabilisation watch

After a week that pushed the 30-year Treasury yield to a 19-year high, any further leg up would pressure equity risk premia at the open.

4. Tritax Big Box GM outcome

Vote on the £350m data-centre capex raise is a live read on AI-infrastructure investor appetite in UK real estate.

5. Airbus/Boeing labour disruption

Strike action starting Monday in European aerospace adds a supply-chain risk overlay to the sector.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. Nvidia Q2 FY2027 earnings (Wed)

Global tech read-through and a key test of the AI-capex cycle narrative that has been driving DCM issuance and equity flows.

2. Jackson Hole & Warsh's first keynote (Fri)

Goldman flags this as a potential major source of FX and rates volatility — the week's dominant policy event.

3. German Ifo Business Climate (Tue)

Follow-through confirmation (or contradiction) of Friday's strong flash PMI print for the eurozone growth narrative.

4. US PCE inflation data

A key input for how markets read Warsh's policy path heading into year-end.

5. September DCM reopening pipeline

Syndicate desks are positioning for a busy autumn; this week's flow (or lack of it) tests post-summer investor appetite.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Fed policy path under Warsh

First Jackson Hole address sets the tone for the rate trajectory into Q4, with hike odds still a live debate.

2. US-Iran conflict trajectory

Whether the standoff resolves or escalates determines if the current oil and shipping risk premium is transient or structural.

3. AI capex cycle and DCM supply wave

Nvidia earnings, hyperscaler bond issuance, and data-centre buildout (Tritax, AT&S) remain the dominant secular theme.

4. Eurozone growth inflection vs. rate backdrop

Improving PMIs collide with Bund yields at multi-decade highs — a genuine test of whether the recovery can hold against tighter financial conditions.

5. Gold / dollar debasement trade

Treasury buyback dynamics and fiscal-sustainability concerns are driving a structural bid for gold at the dollar's expense — watch for continuation or reversal.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Iran/Hormuz headlines: The single biggest intraday risk factor for European energy and shipping names.

European open reaction: Whether Friday's US bounce carries through, given the index still finished the week lower.

Tritax Big Box GM vote: Read on UK data-centre capex appetite.

Brent above \$94: A sustained break higher would intensify the inflation/margin narrative into the week.

1 WEEK

Nvidia earnings (Wed): Sets the tone for global tech and AI-capex sentiment.

Jackson Hole (Thu-Fri): Warsh's first keynote as Fed Chair is the week's dominant policy catalyst.

German Ifo (Tue): Confirmation test for the eurozone growth upside surprise.

September DCM pipeline: Early positioning this week will signal how aggressive the post-summer issuance rush will be.

1 MONTH

Fed rate path under Warsh: Post-Jackson-Hole guidance shapes positioning into Q4 2026.

Iran conflict resolution or escalation: Determines whether the oil/shipping risk premium unwinds or becomes structural.

AI capex and DCM supply wave: Hyperscaler and data-centre-linked issuance continues to dominate primary markets.

ECB dilemma: Bund yields at multi-decade highs against an improving growth backdrop — a genuine policy balancing act into the September meeting.

Gold/dollar debasement trade: Continuation would reinforce the fiscal-sustainability narrative; a reversal would suggest the buyback-driven dollar weakness was transient.

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Data collected automatically between 22 and 24 August 2026 via open web search. Cash markets were closed over the weekend; most index, rates and FX figures reflect Friday 21 August 2026's close, the latest confirmed session. Items marked n/a could not be reliably sourced and require Bloomberg Terminal, Refinitiv Eikon or ICE access for confirmation. Several data providers (TradingEconomics.com, Investing.com, GlobalCapital, IFR) were not directly fetchable from this environment; figures attributed to them came via search-engine snippets, not a direct page read — treat as directionally reliable but verify exact levels before use. Verify before making any decision. This document is not investment advice.